

Role of management, supervisors,
workmen, unions, government and
voluntary agencies in safety.

Role of management in safety

- This might seem obvious, because the role of management in overall workforce output is fundamental.
- Management decisions are at the forefront of working practices and outcomes.
- But when it comes to safety critical areas, it's important to consider the way in which management structures, decision making and overall input can support, enhance and improve best practice.
- It's very easy for complacency to creep into the management of aspects such as workforce safety.
- Where an excellent safety record is demonstrable, aspects such as verbal and written communications can take a backseat, with a regression in their presence or simply a standing still and relying on old systems to continue working.

- Timely payment of compensation
- Compliance of applicant
- Following specific rules and regulations
- Appointment of medical, welfare and safety officers
- Formation of committee(safety, welfare, pollution control, canteen..)
- Education and training employees
- Promote coverage of employee under act

Role of supervisor in safety

- There's an unofficial rule of safety management that goes like this: a safety program will only be as strong as the least effective shift supervisor.
- Every rule has its exceptions, but it's exceedingly difficult to achieve sustained safety success in a workplace where supervisors and other leaders lack the skills and knowledge to support the company's safety efforts.
- Supervisors may not set an organization's direction but they're the ones who are ultimately responsible for translating a company's policies and intentions into action.
- Even when a new safety initiative is driven by the safety officer, at most workplaces it's up to team leaders to oversee it on a daily basis.
- To put it simply, supervisors are where the rubber meets the road.
- If you're skeptical of the impact that supervisors have on safety, try this quick thought experiment.
- The most commonly cited workplace safety challenges include recurring injuries, a lack of worker engagement and buy-in, employees taking shortcuts or not following rules, a lack of personal accountability for safety, and competing organizational priorities.

- Pick any one of these issues and consider how the problem's impact would change if every supervisor in the workplace had strong communication skills, understood advanced safety concepts like human factors, and had experience with empowering their team to improve on the issue.
- It's not hard to imagine that safety-oriented supervisors would result in employees taking fewer shortcuts and more personal accountability for their own safety.
- Workers would feel more engaged and more capable of focusing on production without casting safety by the wayside. And, essentially, supervisors could be an effective liaison between the safety manager and workers in an effort to root out repeated injuries.
- Now picture the opposite: a set of supervisors who lack the ability to have difficult safety conversations with workers, who aren't able to spot safety issues (let alone anticipate them before they occur), and who are unpracticed in leading with a safety-first mindset.

- Supervisors aren't magicians, of course. They're only one of many factors that determine a workplace's overall degree of safety success.
- The best team of supervisors in the world can't overcome a flimsy organizational safety program.
- But the inverse is also true—it's hard to see how an otherwise strong safety system can succeed at the highest level with frontline leaders who simply don't 'get' safety.
- In effect, supervisors represent an invisible ceiling on safety outcomes.
- Once we acknowledge supervisors' importance to workplace safety, big questions arise. Which specific traits determine a supervisor's impact on safety? And how can safety managers and senior leaders foster the right mix of supervisory skills and knowledge to improve safety results?
- SafeStart has conducted extensive research into the essential components for supervisors to influence worker's safety attitudes and actions, and we've discovered that, across almost every industry, geographic region and size of company, there are six main qualities that can make or break a supervisor's ability to move the needle on safety outcomes.
- Notably, these qualities are all variable—everyone naturally possesses them to differing degrees, can improve them through teaching and practice, and can lose them through lack of use. This means that business leaders who want to better leverage supervisors' impact on safety should take steps to instill or improve these six traits in supervisors through training mentorship.

Role of workmen in safety

- Workers are responsible for their own safety on the job.
- This means that they have the right to refuse to do any act or operate any tool, appliance, or equipment when they have reasonable cause to believe that to do so would put them in danger. The employer must ensure that:
- All work is carried out without undue risk of injury or industrial disease
- Machinery and equipment are capable of safely performing the functions for which they are used
- All permanent and temporary buildings and structures are capable of withstanding any stresses likely to be imposed on them
- All buildings, excavation structures, machinery, equipment, tools, and places of employment are maintained in good condition so workers will not be endangered
- Regular inspections are made to prevent structures, grounds, excavations, tools, equipment, machinery, and work from becoming unsafe
- Any unsafe conditions are corrected without delay

- Each worker is supplied, at no cost, with all protective safety equipment required by WorkSafeBC regulations
- All workers are instructed in the safe performance of their duties • An accident prevention program is set up
- There is a safe means of entry to and exit from the work area
- Firefighting equipment is provided and maintained
- Workers with physical or mental impairment are not assigned to work where their impairment endangers themselves or others
- No one enters or remains, or is permitted to remain, on the premises of any place of employment while that person's ability to work is so affected by alcohol, drugs, or other substances as to endanger his or her health or safety, or that of any other person.

As a worker, you should keep the following personal responsibilities in mind:

- You must not remove any safety equipment from machines or equipment. This includes shields from grinders, mixers, etc.
- You must have had adequate instruction about a piece of machinery or equipment before you use it.
- You must make sure that no machine, equipment, or tool is used in a way that would cause injury to someone else.
- You must make sure that there are safe entrances to and exits from the workplace.
- You must make sure that the work area is safe for the movement of workers, equipment, and materials.
- You must wear protective eyewear when using grinders and other equipment that may be hazardous to the eyes.

Role of unions in safety

- Your workers deserve safe and fair working conditions. But before labour unions, they didn't have much power to negotiate for such conditions.
- Today, labour unions have huge sway over workplace safety standards, for unionized and nonunionized workers alike.
- And if your company wants to thrive, you have to be willing to come to the negotiating table.
- A study of right-to-work laws published in the BMJ Occupational & Environmental Medicine journal found that a 1% decrease in unionization resulted in a 5% increase in occupational fatalities.
- In Kansas, Missouri, and Nebraska, all states with right-to-work laws, there was a notable increase in workplace deaths due to falls, machine hazards, and struck-by hazards.
- And in construction, often regarded as one of the most dangerous industries in the country, a survey showed that construction firms with union workers were far more likely to engage in safety practices than those with non-union workers.
- There are many theories as to why unions help promote workplace safety.

- One likely explanation is worker protection.
- Under the wing of labour unions, workers are free to speak up about safety hazards without fear of retaliation.
- And because unions can put pressure on employers to fix safety problems, employers are incentivized to fix and prevent problems – or face significant productivity losses.
- One of the biggest advantages unions have is the power of collective bargaining.
- An individual worker can often feel that they don't have a voice, or that if they speak up alone, they won't have much power to affect change.
- By joining a union, workers agree to bargain for their rights as a collective entity.
- This gives them far greater leverage to bargain for things like better safety conditions, improved wages, and reasonable work hours.
- The fact that they cover an entire group forces employers to come to the table

Of course, the work of a labour union doesn't end with reaching a collective bargaining agreement.

- Once an agreement is reached, union representatives work with employees and management to ensure that the terms of the agreement are honoured on both sides.
- Unions can influence the safety of all workers because of two things:
 - 1. Restriction of labour supply
 - 2. Increase in labour demand
- Companies need workers. But workers have the right to a safe and fair working environment.
- Unions leverage this by increasing the demand for union laborers, which in turn forces companies to negotiate with them to access union workers.
- This, in turn, sets the standard for non-union workers.
- A specific workplace may not be unionized, but an industry is – and that means that the workplace must comply with industry standards.

Role of government in safety

- Government legislation is what **provides workers with minimum standards of health and safety in the workplace**. Minimum standards, however, can always be made more protective with stronger legislation.
- The Constitution of India provide detailed provisions for the rights of the citizens and also lays down the Directive Principles of State Policy which set an aim to which the activities of the state are to be guided.
- On the basis of these Directive Principles as well as international instruments, Government is committed to regulate all economic activities for management of safety and health risks at workplaces and to provide measures so as to ensure safe and healthy working conditions for every working man and woman in the nation.
- Government recognizes that safety and health of workers has a positive impact on productivity and economic and social development.
- Prevention is an integral part of economic activities as high safety and health standard at work is as important as good business performance for new as well as existing industries.

Role of local Government in promoting safety in work environment

- Create workers' boards and other safety bodies to set industry wide standards.
- Promote worksite safety through worker safety inspectors or committees.
- Strengthen government enforcement of workplace safety standards.
- Provide striking workers with access to unemployment insurance

Role of the local authority in health and safety

- HSE and local authorities (LAs) are responsible for **enforcing health and safety legislation**.
- Together they ensure that dutyholders manage the health and safety of their workforce and those affected by their work.

Role of voluntary agencies in safety

- A voluntary agency is a non governmental autonomous, non profit organization supported mainly by voluntary contribution in cash and time from the general public or the certain segment of the public, specialized to carry out a number of functions related to development aid and emergency relief. Eg: CARE(Cooperative for assistance and relief everywhere), Redcross, ILO(International Labour Organization)
- Some of the functions
 - To serve individuals and families in the world's poorest communities.
 - To promote innovative solutions and advocate for global responsibility.
 - To deliver relief in emergencies.
 - To influence policy decisions at all levels.
 - To meet international standards of quality and accountability